

Green Ash

Fraxinus pennsylvanica



Origin

Native to central and eastern North America, especially along rivers and floodplains, once one of the most commonly planted street trees in the US.

Look for

Ash leaves and branches always grow in exact opposite pairs, not staggered -- a quick and reliable way to rule in or rule out ash on any city block.

IDENTIFICATION TIPS

- Branching: always opposite pairs, never staggered -- the single most reliable ash clue.
- Leaf: compound leaf made of several leaflets along one central stalk.
- Bark: diamond-patterned ridges on older trunks.
- Commonly confused with: other compound-leaved trees, but ash's strict opposite branching rules most of them out.

THROUGH THE SEASONS

Spring	Compound leaves emerge in opposite pairs along the stem.
Summer	Leaflets give a soft, feathery green canopy.
Fall	Leaves turn yellow.
Winter	Distinct diamond-patterned bark ridges are visible on older trunks.

DID YOU KNOW

- Green ash populations have been devastated across North America since 2002 by the emerald ash borer, an invasive beetle accidentally introduced from Asia in shipping material.
- Because so many street ashes have died, many cities now avoid replanting ash at all to prevent repeating a single-species vulnerability.